NeoStats AI Engineer Intern Hackathon

RideWise Assist

Problem Statement & Participant Guidelines

Event detail	Information
Date	Saturday, 10 October 2026
Venue	NeoStats office
Format	Individual
Build time	3 hours
Document version	1.0

Please read this document fully before the event begins.

1. Overview

Welcome to the NeoStats AI Engineer Intern Hackathon. Over three hours, you will build an AI assistant modelled on the kind of solutions NeoStats delivers to its clients: one that a real business can trust with its customers, its staff and its data.

We are not looking for the flashiest demo. We are looking for engineers who make deliberate design decisions and genuinely understand what they build.

At a glance

Item	Summary
The challenge	Build RideWise Assist, a conversational AI assistant that answers questions from customers and support agents using a company database and policy documents
Format	Individual, 3 hours of build time
You receive	A SQLite database, a data dictionary and five policy documents
You submit	A Git repository with your code and documentation
Evaluation	Live testing on unseen questions, followed by a short technical discussion

> **On AI coding tools**
>
> AI-assisted IDEs such as Cursor and Antigravity are allowed. Using them well is a skill we value. You must, however, be able to explain every part of your submission.

2. Business Context

RideWise is a two-wheeler and electric-vehicle rental company operating from multiple hubs across Bengaluru. Customers book bikes, scooters and EVs by the hour or by the day through the RideWise app and collect them from a hub.

RideWise's support desk handles hundreds of queries every day: customers ask about their bookings, payments, refunds, charges and the rental rules, while support agents need operational information to resolve issues and to answer questions from management. The answers are spread across two sources:

Source	What it contains
Operational database	Customers, vehicles, bookings, payments and damage records
Policy documents	Rental terms, cancellation and refund rules, penalty schedules and EV guidelines

Today, agents check both sources, interpret the policies and calculate charges by hand. The process is slow, inconsistent and error-prone, and it does not scale with RideWise's growth.

3. Problem Statement

> **Your challenge**
>
> Build **RideWise Assist**: a conversational AI assistant that accurately answers questions from RideWise customers and support agents, using RideWise's operational database and its policy documents.

RideWise intends to place this assistant in front of real customers and real staff. Treat your solution as the first version of a production system: it must be **correct**, **trustworthy** and **robust**, not merely impressive in a demonstration.

4. Users & Access

RideWise Assist serves two types of user. Each has different needs and different entitlements, and your assistant must respect them.

	Customer	Support Agent
Who they are	A registered RideWise customer, identified by their customer_id	A RideWise employee working at the support desk or in hub operations
Typical needs	Information about their own account, bookings, payments and charges, and about RideWise's rules and policies	Operational information across RideWise to resolve customer issues and support management, and RideWise's rules and policies
Entitled to	Their own information and RideWise's published policies	The operational information needed for their work, and RideWise's policies
Not entitled to	Other customers' information, or RideWise's internal operational information	Anything beyond what their work requires. Customer data must still be handled responsibly.

For evaluation, the role is selected when a session starts (see Section 7). In a real deployment this would come from authentication; you do not need to build a login system. You may add one optionally if time permits.

5. What We Provide

Resource	Details
Database	ridewise.db: a SQLite database with 5 tables (summarised in Appendix A)
Data dictionary	data_dictionary.md: a description of every table and column
Document pack	5 PDF documents covering RideWise's terms and policies (listed in Appendix B)
LLM access	A NeoStats-hosted LLM. The endpoint, API key and model name are shared at the start of the event.

Use only the LLM and credentials provided by NeoStats. Other providers, personal API keys and locally run models are not allowed. The credentials are for this event only, may be rate-limited, and will be deactivated after evaluation. Never share them or commit them to your repository.

> **Read everything**
> Read every file in the pack carefully before you start building. Everything provided is there for a reason.

6. What RideWise Expects

The expectations below describe what RideWise needs from its assistant. Deciding what each one means in engineering terms is part of the challenge, and a significant part of the evaluation.

Expectation	What RideWise needs
Accurate	Correct answers, whether they come from the data, the documents, or both
Conversational	Keeps up with how people actually talk
Responsible	Serves each user according to their entitlements, and protects the company's data and systems
Honest & verifiable	Never makes things up, and its answers can be checked
Robust	Copes with real users, real data and a changing business

7. Minimum Requirements

These requirements are mandatory, so that every submission can be evaluated consistently.

1. A **chat interface**, built with any framework (Streamlit, Gradio, React or similar).
2. The evaluator can start a session **as a specific customer** (by entering a customer_id) or **as a support agent**.
3. The evaluator can **start a new conversation** at any time.
4. The application runs locally by following your README, with setup taking **no more than 10 minutes**.

8. Rules

Allowed

- Any programming language (Python recommended) and any open-source framework or library.
- AI-assisted IDEs and coding tools, and internet access for documentation.

Not allowed

- Collaborating with, or sharing code with, other participants. This is an individual hackathon.
- Using pre-built solutions or any project code written before the event. (Setting up tools and accounts beforehand is encouraged.)
- Using any data other than the provided pack, or modifying the provided database or documents.
- Hard-coding answers. You will be evaluated on questions you have not seen.

- Using any LLM other than the one provided by NeoStats.
- Sharing the provided LLM credentials, or committing them to your repository.

Important

- Commit to Git **regularly**. Your commit history is part of your submission.
- The organisers may share **additional information during the event**. Watch for announcements.
- Rule violations may lead to disqualification at the organisers' discretion.

9. Deliverables

Submit the following via [submission link] **before the 3-hour deadline**. Late submissions will not be accepted, and your last commit before the deadline is treated as final.

Deliverable	Contents
Source code	A Git repository with full commit history and a .env.example file (no API keys or secrets)
README.md	Setup and run steps, how the provided LLM credentials are configured (through environment variables), and an architecture overview (a diagram is encouraged)
DECISIONS.md	About one page, answering the questions below

DECISIONS.md must answer:

1. What were your three most important design decisions, and why?
2. Which alternatives did you consider and reject?
3. Where does your assistant currently fail or behave poorly?
4. What would you build next with one more week?

10. Evaluation

After the build, the panel will test your assistant live, in both roles, using a **hidden set of questions** reflecting how real customers and support agents use it. This is followed by a short technical discussion with you (about 10 minutes).

Criterion	What we look for	Weight
Correctness	Accurate answers across all kinds of questions	30%
Trust & Safety	Responsible handling of data, users, entitlements and system access	15%
Conversational Quality	Natural, coherent, context-aware interaction	15%
Adaptability	How well your system handles change	10%
Transparency	How verifiable and explainable the answers are	10%
Engineering Quality	Code structure, README and DECISIONS.md	10%

Criterion	What we look for	Weight
Technical Discussion	Depth of understanding of your own system	10%

> **What wins**
> A simpler assistant that behaves correctly and responsibly will score higher than a feature-rich one that behaves unpredictably.

The panel's decision is final. Shortlisted participants will be contacted regarding the next steps of the intern hiring process.

11. Tips from the Panel

- Read everything provided before writing any code, and spend the first 15 minutes thinking, not prompting.
- Test your assistant the way your harshest user would, in both roles.
- Your AI coding tool will build whatever you ask for. The skill lies in knowing what to ask for.
- If an answer looks right, verify it anyway.
- A stable, smaller system beats an ambitious one that fails during evaluation.

12. Frequently Asked Questions

LLM & embeddings

Q. Which LLMs can I use?
Only the NeoStats-hosted model provided at the start of the event. Other providers, personal API keys and locally run models are not allowed.

Q. Will API keys be provided?
Yes. NeoStats shares the endpoint, API key and model name at the start of the event. Keep them in environment variables and never commit them; include a .env.example file in your repository instead.

Q. What about embeddings?
Use the embedding model provided with the credentials, if one is included. If none is provided, you may run an open-source embedding model locally.

Q. What if the model is slow or rate-limited during evaluation?
Your application must remain usable throughout evaluation. The provided credentials may be rate-limited, so plan your usage, and make sure your assistant handles a slow or unavailable model gracefully.

Build & submission

Q. Can I use frameworks such as LangChain, LangGraph or LlamaIndex?
Yes. Use whatever helps you build a better system.

Q. Can I add tables or change the schema?

You may create your own supporting stores (vector indexes, caches, logs), but the provided database and documents must remain unmodified.

Q. Is a polished UI important?
Not significantly. A clean, functional interface is enough. Focus on how the assistant behaves.

Q. Will I receive the evaluation questions?
No. Build for real users, not for a test set.

Before the event

Q. What should I set up in advance?
Your own laptop and charger, plus a mobile hotspot as a backup connection; Python 3.10 or above; Git and an active GitHub account; a code editor of your choice; and a SQLite viewer such as DB Browser for SQLite. No LLM provider account or API key is needed. Set up only your environment: writing code before the event is not allowed.

Appendix A: Data Dictionary Summary

SQLite stores dates and timestamps as ISO-8601 text. **All timestamps are in UTC.** All monetary values are in Indian Rupees (₹). The full dictionary is in data_dictionary.md.

A.1 customers

Column	Type	Description
customer_id	TEXT (PK)	Unique customer ID, format CUST0001
full_name	TEXT	Customer's full name
phone	TEXT	Registered 10-digit mobile number
email	TEXT	Registered email address
city	TEXT	City the customer registered from
date_of_birth	TEXT (DATE)	Date of birth, YYYY-MM-DD
driving_license_no	TEXT	Driving licence number
kyc_status	TEXT	VERIFIED, PENDING or REJECTED
customer_tier	TEXT	STANDARD, SILVER or GOLD (tiers affect certain policy benefits)
created_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Account creation time (UTC)

A.2 vehicles

Column	Type	Description
vehicle_id	TEXT (PK)	Unique vehicle ID, format VEH001
registration_no	TEXT	Registration plate, e.g. KA-05-EV-221
vehicle_type	TEXT	BIKE, SCOOTER, EV_SCOOTER or EV_BIKE
model	TEXT	Make and model name
hub_name	TEXT	Pickup hub, e.g. Koramangala, Whitefield
hourly_rate	REAL	Rental rate per hour (₹)
daily_rate	REAL	Rental rate per 24 hours (₹)
battery_capacity_kwh	REAL	Battery capacity in kWh; NULL for non-EV vehicles
status	TEXT	ACTIVE, MAINTENANCE or RETIRED
commissioned_on	TEXT (DATE)	Date the vehicle joined the fleet

A.3 bookings

Column	Type	Description
booking_id	TEXT (PK)	Unique booking ID, format B-0001
customer_id	TEXT (FK)	References customers.customer_id

Column	Type	Description
vehicle_id	TEXT (FK)	References vehicles.vehicle_id
booked_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	When the booking was made (UTC)
scheduled_start	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Planned pickup time (UTC)
scheduled_end	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Planned return time (UTC)
actual_return_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Actual return time (UTC); NULL if not returned
cancelled_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Cancellation time (UTC); NULL if not cancelled
booking_status	TEXT	UPC = upcoming, ONG = ongoing, CMP = completed, CNL_U = cancelled by customer, CNL_S = cancelled by RideWise, NSH = no-show
return_battery_pct	INTEGER	Battery percentage at return (EVs only); NULL otherwise

A.4 payments

Column	Type	Description
payment_id	TEXT (PK)	Unique payment ID, format PAY00001
booking_id	TEXT (FK)	References bookings.booking_id
payment_type	TEXT	BOOKING, DEPOSIT, PENALTY or REFUND
amount	REAL	Amount in ₹ excluding GST; refunds are recorded as negative values
gst_amount	REAL	GST charged on the transaction (₹)
payment_method	TEXT	UPI, CARD, WALLET or CASH
payment_status	TEXT	SUCCESS, FAILED or PENDING
transaction_ref	TEXT	Payment gateway transaction reference
paid_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Transaction time (UTC)
remarks	TEXT	Free-text notes from the payment system or staff

A.5 damage_reports

Column	Type	Description
report_id	TEXT (PK)	Unique report ID, format DMG0001
booking_id	TEXT (FK)	References bookings.booking_id
vehicle_id	TEXT (FK)	References vehicles.vehicle_id
reported_by	TEXT	CUSTOMER or HUB_STAFF

Column	Type	Description
damage_category	TEXT	SCRATCH, DENT, TYRE, BATTERY, LOST_KEY or OTHER
severity	TEXT	LOW, MEDIUM or HIGH
description	TEXT	Free-text description of the damage
assessed_cost	REAL	Repair cost assessed by the hub (₹)
claim_status	TEXT	OPEN, CHARGED, WAIVED or DISPUTED
reported_at	TEXT (TIMESTAMP)	Report time (UTC)

Appendix B: Document Pack

#	Document	Covers
1	Rental Agreement & Terms	General rental terms, eligibility and KYC
2	Cancellation & Refund Policy (v1)	Cancellation and refund rules
3	Cancellation & Refund Policy (v2)	Revised cancellation and refund rules
4	Late Return & Damage Penalty Schedule	Penalties and charges
5	EV User Guide & FAQ	EV usage, charging, range and breakdown support

Good luck. Build something you would trust in production.

NeoStats AI Team